Accessibility Testing

Inclusion Toolkit

What is it for?

Accessibility Testing is the process of checking a digital product to ensure it can be used by people with disabilities. Its purpose is to find and fix barriers before your users do. Without testing, you're guessing if your product works for everyone. This can lead to significant problems, such as:

- People using screen readers or keyboards are blocked from completing tasks
- Users with disabilities face a broken or frustrating product
- Your product may fail to meet legal requirements based on Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG)
- Problems found after launch are much harder and more expensive to fix

How to support it

An effective strategy combines three testing methods:

- Automated software scans code for basic flaws, but it only finds about 30% of issues
- Manual testing relies on humans to check complex areas, including keyboard navigation, zoom levels, and screen reader support
- User testing gathers feedback from people with disabilities, which is the only way to prove a site is 'truly usable'

Useful Links

Best Practices for Accessibility Testing - A Comprehensive Guide

The Importance Of Manual Accessibility Testing

Accessibility Testing: How It Works and Why It's Important